

Evan M. Reeves

Quantum Computing Researcher

Experimental hardware • Real-hardware benchmarking • Qubit simulation and control

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Website • Google Scholar • ORCID • LinkedIn

Research Profile

Experimental quantum researcher and licensed Professional Engineer building accessible instruments and evaluating what real quantum processors can deliver. Work spans low-cost NMR and ODMR hardware, multi-architecture benchmarking, superconducting-qubit simulation, and QICK-based control.

Education

Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering, expected 2027

University of Illinois Chicago

Advisor: Thomas A. Searles. Research in accessible quantum hardware, multi-architecture benchmarking, and qubit simulation and control.

2023–Present

Chicago, IL

M.S. in Physics

Northern Illinois University

Advisor: Laurence Lurio. Graduate research in materials characterization and particle detection.

2015

DeKalb, IL

B.S. in Applied Physics

Northern Illinois University

Minors in Applied Mathematics and Japanese Studies. Undergraduate research in transmission electron microscopy.

2011

DeKalb, IL

Additional education: M.P.S., Purdue Global (2025); Master in Big Data and Business Intelligence, ENEB (2024); Executive M.B.A., Quantic (2023); A.E.S., Harper College (2012).

Research and Entrepreneurship Experience

Research Assistant

University of Illinois Chicago

2024–Present

Chicago, IL

- Develop hardware-aware benchmarking workflows for the Quantum Permutation Algorithm across multiple quantum architectures, including execution and performance analysis on IBM superconducting hardware.
- Design and integrate low-cost NMR and ODMR instrumentation for undergraduate quantum information science laboratories.
- Perform electromagnetic simulation of superconducting qubits in Ansys HFSS and develop QICK-based control experiments involving pulse timing and qubit cloaking.
- Collaborate on applied quantum research in chemistry, finance, and edge-based state reconstruction; mentor undergraduates across ECE, computer science, and engineering physics.

Co-Founder and Chief Financial Officer

SpinQuorum

2025–Present

Chicago, IL

- Translate low-cost quantum-instrumentation research into a desktop NMR platform for education and workforce development.
- Define technical priorities, resource plans, budgets, and organizational strategy for an early-stage quantum hardware initiative.

Independent Researcher, Low-Cost NMR Quantum Computing

2021–Present

Hoffman Estates, IL

- Designed custom control electronics for a low-cost single-qubit NMR system and supported prototyping, testing, troubleshooting, and technical communication.

Publications and Proceedings

Blackwell, A. N., **Reeves, E. M.**, Khannejad, A., Strickland, E. M., Metwalli, S. A., Gomez, E., Salonis, C., Chase, Z. A., Glasser, R. T., Kirby, B. T., Lohani, S., & Searles, T. A. (2026). *Benchmarking noisy-intermediate scale hardware with the Quantum Permutation Algorithm: A case study on IBM Sherbrooke*. Quantum 2.0 Conference and Exhibition, paper QTu3A.18, Glasgow, United Kingdom.

Viti, I., **Reeves, E. M.**, Elisma, D., Chandler, J., & Searles, T. A. (2026). *A compact, portable spectrometer for NMR measurements in undergraduate education labs*. Accepted, IEEE Quantum Week 2026, Toronto, Canada.

Viti, I., **Reeves, E. M.**, Elisma, D., Chandler, J., & Searles, T. A. (2026). *A low-cost optically detectable magnetic resonance device*. Accepted, IEEE Quantum Week 2026, Toronto, Canada.

Conference Presentations

Oral Presentations

- 2026 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., Elisma, D., Chandler, J., & Searles, T. A. “Low-cost quantum information science laboratory devices.” AAPT Summer Meeting, Pasadena, CA.
- 2026 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., Elisma, D., Chandler, J., & Searles, T. A. “A low-cost nuclear magnetic resonance quantum computer.” Chicago and Illinois Sections of AAPT Spring Meeting, Palatine, IL.
- 2026 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., Elisma, D., Chandler, J., & Searles, T. A. “A low-cost nuclear magnetic resonance quantum computer.” APS Global Physics Summit, Denver, CO.
- 2026 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., & Searles, T. A. “A quantum computer you can build at home.” Olive-Harvey Quantum Symposium, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 Blackwell, A. N., **Reeves, E. M.**, et al. “Hardware-aware performance evaluation of the Quantum Permutation Algorithm.” 18th U.S. National Congress on Computational Mechanics, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., Yekeh, C., & Searles, T. A. “A low-cost nuclear magnetic resonance quantum computer.” Northrop Grumman-UIC Quantum Technology Meeting, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., Yekeh, C., & Searles, T. A. “A low-cost nuclear magnetic resonance quantum computer.” IBM HBCU Quantum Center QuERC Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., & Searles, T. A. “A low-cost nuclear magnetic resonance quantum computer.” NSBP-NSHP Joint Conference, San Jose, CA.
- 2024 **Reeves, E. M.**, Flanigan, A., & Searles, T. A. “Qubit cloaking on superconducting qubits using Qiskit Pulse and Superstaq.” NSBP-NSHP Joint Conference, Houston, TX.

Poster Presentations

- 2026 Regmi, S., **Reeves, E. M.**, Meena, A., Zorzetti, S., Lohani, S., & Searles, T. A. “AI-assisted scalable quantum state reconstruction at edge devices.” University of Illinois Superconducting Circuits Conference, Urbana, IL.
- 2025 **Reeves, E. M.**, Viti, I., & Searles, T. A. “A quantum computer you can build at home.” Fermilab SQMS Center Annual Meeting, Batavia, IL.
- 2025 Blackwell, A. N., **Reeves, E. M.**, et al. “Hardware-aware performance evaluation of the Quantum Permutation Algorithm.” Chicago Quantum Symposium, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 Blackwell, A. N., **Reeves, E. M.**, et al. “Hardware-aware performance evaluation of the Quantum Permutation Algorithm.” UIC Computational Research Symposium, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 Gerding, G., **Reeves, E. M.**, & Searles, T. A. “Qiskit Ansys HFSS finite-element simulation of superconducting qubits.” IBM HBCU Quantum Center QuERC Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.
- 2023 **Reeves, E. M.** “Quantum computing for traffic signal optimization.” U.S. Quantum Information Science Summer School, Batavia, IL.
- 2011 **Reeves, E. M.**, Shurgin, R., & Ito, Y. “Quantitative 3D analysis of nanostructures by TEM anaglyph imaging.” NIU Undergraduate Research and Artistry Day, DeKalb, IL.

Contributed and Co-Authored Presentations

- 2026 Shahbazi, H., Mewali, S., Bagheritabar, M., **Reeves, E. M.**, Prasad, V. K., Searles, T. A., & Chase, Z. A. “Quantum diagonalization-aided design and validation of catalytic pathways for multi-carbon products in CO₂ electroreduction.” APS Global Physics Summit, Denver, CO.
- 2025 Flanigan, A., **Reeves, E. M.**, & Searles, T. A. “Translating two- and three-qubit circuits from Qiskit to Cirq.” IBM HBCU Quantum Center QuERC Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 Yekeh, C., Viti, I., **Reeves, E. M.**, & Searles, T. A. “Development of a low-cost NMR quantum computer.” IBM HBCU Quantum Center QuERC Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.
- 2024 Regmi, S., **Reeves, E. M.**, Zorzetti, S., Lohani, S., & Searles, T. A. “Mitigating multidimensionality challenges of quantum state reconstruction at edge devices.” NSBP Annual Conference, Houston, TX.

Engineering and Organizational Experience

Civil Engineer III

Illinois Department of Transportation

2024–Present

Schaumburg, IL

- Lead staff, workflows, reporting, and quality-assurance testing for roadway materials supporting infrastructure contracts valued at more than \$400 million in an accredited laboratory environment.

Earlier Engineering Roles

Illinois Department of Transportation

2016–2024

District 1, IL

Electrical Engineer (2023–2024); Civil Construction Resident Engineer (2021); Senior Engineering Technician (2016–2020)

- Developed systems for inventory, infrastructure mapping, machine-learning aggregate detection, calibration, automation, and laboratory modernization using Python, SQL, Access, Fortran, VB.NET, and VBA.
- Oversaw roadway and bridge field execution and conducted statewide and District 1 research on concrete resistivity, the Illinois Flexibility Index Test, and testing uniformity.

Co-Founder and Chief Executive Officer

Attic Entertainment, LLC

2015–2022

Hoffman Estates, IL

- Produced a three-day gaming convention for more than 1,000 attendees; led more than 100 employees and contractors and managed RFP-based site selection, budgets, vendors, and operations.

Graduate and Undergraduate Researcher

Northern Illinois University

2011–2014

DeKalb, IL

- Characterized ceramic perovskites using x-ray diffraction and thermogravimetric analysis; supported QuarkNet detector software and produced TEM-based 3D reconstructions of MgO nanostructures.

Teaching and Mentorship

- Mentor undergraduate researchers in computer science, electrical engineering, and engineering physics across multiple institutions, including a 2025 UIC electrical-engineering capstone team.
- Designated IDOT laboratory trainer for testing procedures and annual activities supporting AASHTO accreditation review (2018–2021; 2024–Present).
- Academic tutor in calculus, engineering, physics, statistics, and related subjects for secondary through graduate-level learners (2012–2021).
- Graduate Teaching Assistant for undergraduate electricity and magnetism laboratories at Northern Illinois University (2012).

Licenses, Certifications, Service, and Honors

Licenses: Professional Engineer, Illinois (2025); Professional Engineer, Wyoming (2022).

Certifications: Project Management Professional (2020); Certified Meeting Professional (2021).

Selected service: Union Steward and Bargaining Committee Member, UIC Graduate Employee Organization (2025–2026); Founder and Program Director, The GG Initiative (2020).

Honor: Teamsters Local 916 Scholarship (2025).

Selected affiliations: IEEE; APS; AAPT; ACM; NSBP; NSBE; NSPE; PMI.

Technical Skills

Quantum and scientific computing: Qiskit, QICK, Cirq, PennyLane, Amazon Braket SDK, qBraid, Superstaq, QASM, Ansys HFSS.

Programming and hardware description: Python, SQL, C#, C++, Java, Fortran, R, VBA, VB.NET, Verilog, VHDL, LaTeX, HTML, CSS, XML.

Engineering and analysis software: AutoCAD, FreeCAD, SolidWorks, Maple, Mathcad, Mathematica, Octave, PSpice.

Experimental methods: NMR and ODMR system development, optical microscopy, AFM, SEM, TEM, x-ray diffraction, thermogravimetric analysis.